The Starter Prompt Pack: Characters & Cinematic Shots

For beginners who don’t know where to start

by AI Video Strategy



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Welcome!
I am excited that you are here... In this ebook, I will break down info that took me MONTHS to learn.
Let's start creating!

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Part 1: The AI Video Toolbox

NOTE: AI video tools change almost every month. Don't try to memorize names. Understand the types of tools and you'll know where any new tool fits.

The 4 types of tools

1. Video generators

Create a short video clip from a text prompt (text-to-video) or from a still image (image-to-video). This is the heart of AI video and what most prompts in this guide are for.

2. Image generators

Create your characters, scenes and first frames. Many creators design a character as an image first, then animate it. This helps keep the same face across shots.

3. Voice, music and sound tools

Create voiceovers, music and effects. Note that several of the major video models can now generate synchronized audio on their own, so you may not need a separate tool for every clip.

4. Editing and avatar tools

Put clips together, add subtitles, fix details or create talking presenters (avatars).

Part 2: How an AI Video Is Made

An AI video is not made with one prompt. It is built in stages, the same way a film is. Once you know the stages, you always know what to do next.
The flow:
Idea → Script & shots → Images → Video clips → Sound → Edit & export

Stage 1: Idea

-Decide what the video is about, who it's for, and what feeling it should create.
-Answer 3 questions:
What is the video about?
Where will it be published?
How long will it be?

Tip: Small ideas work best. "A lone astronaut walks through a neon city at night" is better than "a sci-fi epic."

Stage 2: Script & shot list

-Break the idea into individual shots. Each shot is one short clip, usually 3 to 8 seconds.
Example shot list :
Wide view of a neon-lit alley → Slow push in
Astronaut walking, seen from behind → Tracking shot
Close-up of the helmet reflecting the lights → Static

Tip: AI video works best in short shots, not long scenes. Think in clips, then connect them.

Stage 3: Images & characters

-Create your character and key scenes as still images first.
Why this stage matters: An image gives you control. You approve the look of the character before you spend time animating. It also helps you keep the same character across all shots(consistency) , which is the biggest challenge for beginners.
Tools: AI image generators.

Tip: Create one strong "base" image of your character, then reuse it as a reference for every shot.

Stage 4: Video generation

-Turn your images (or prompts) into moving clips.
How:
Upload your image as the starting frame, or write a text prompt.
Describe the action and camera movement
Generate 2 to 4 versions of each shot. Keep the best one.
Tools: AI video generators

Tip: Expect to generate each shot more than once. Even professionals pick the best of several attempts. This is normal, not a failure.

Stage 5: Voice, music & sound

-Add voiceover, music and sound effects.
Options:
Voiceover: record your own voice or use an AI voice tool.
Music: use royalty-free or AI-generated music.
Sound effects: footsteps, wind, city noise. These make a video feel real.

Tip: Sound is half of the experience. A good soundtrack makes average clips feel cinematic.

Stage 6: Edit & export

-Put the clips in order, trim them, add subtitles and export.
Checklist:
Match the clip order to your shot list
Add subtitles (most people watch with the sound off)
Add a short intro hook (first 1 to 2 seconds)
Export in the right format- 9:16 for Reels, TikTok and Shorts, 16:9 for YouTube

Tools: any video editor, for example CapCut, Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve

How to use this section

- Copy the image prompt into your image tool.
- Replace the [BRACKETS] with your own details.
- Upload your favorite result into your video tool and paste the video prompt.
- Generate a few versions and keep the best.







CHARACTERS

1. Your Base Character



Every other prompt starts from this image.
Image prompt:
Ultra realistic portrait of [AGE] [GENDER] with [HAIR], wearing [OUTFIT], calm expression, facing the camera, plain soft grey background, soft studio lighting, cinematic photo style
-Of course is better to give more details if you want a specific character or use a reference photo of the internet.
Video prompt:
The character blinks and slowly turns toward the camera, subtle breathing, static camera
Tip: Save this image and reuse it as a reference.

2. Same Character, New Place



Image prompt: (upload your base image)
Keep the same face, hair and outfit exactly. Place the character in [LOCATION], matching natural lighting, cinematic photo style
Video prompt:
The character looks around slowly, then looks into the camera, slow push-in
Tip: Change only the location, nothing else.

3. Character in Motion



Image prompt: (upload your base image)
Keep the same character. Show them mid-step, walking toward the camera in [LOCATION], cinematic photo style
Video prompt:
The character walks steadily toward the camera, natural steps, smooth backward tracking shot, shallow depth of field
Tip: Walking is reliable. Running and fighting are harder.



4. The Establishing Shot

Video prompt:
Wide establishing shot of [PLACE] at [TIME OF DAY], [WEATHER], soft atmospheric light, slow push-in, cinematic film look
Tip: Add one moving detail, like fog or traffic lights



5. The Tracking Shot

Video prompt:
[SUBJECT] walking through [PLACE], seen from behind, slow tracking shot following the subject, [LIGHTING], cinematic 35mm film look
Tip: Say clearly that the camera follows the subject.



6. The Low Angle Hero Shot

Video prompt:
Low angle shot looking up at [SUBJECT] standing confidently, [BACKGROUND: dramatic sky / city skyline], wind in the clothes, slow push-in, cinematic
Tip: Looking up at a subject makes it feel strong.

⚠ This ebook is just the tip of the iceberg.
Every step covered here has deeper layers, nuanced techniques and proven shortcuts waiting for you. Don't stop at the basics.
[UNLOCK THE FULL PLAYBOOK]
Tap here to access exclusive resources, templates and advanced tips.

Who Am I

Hi, I'm the creator behind AI Video Strategy.
My name is Vasia, you can call me Vi.

I studied Communication and Marketing, but very early on, I realized something critical: traditional marketing playbooks were becoming outdated overnight.
With AI evolving at lightning speed, simply having a degree wouldn't be enough. I knew that meant being left behind.
I believe AI video is the defining future of media, we are already heading toward an era where entire cinema productions and commercial campaigns will feature AI actors and virtual sets.

So, I took control of my own trajectory. I didn't wait for a curriculum to catch up. Over the past year, I invested heavily in paid courses, studied countless masterclasses, tested dozens of tools and engineered hundreds of prompts through relentless trial and error.





Today, I work as a freelancer helping businesses produce high-converting AI video ads and scale their social media presence. Everything in this guide comes straight from that hands-on client work, distilling what actually performs versus what only looks good in theory.

It took me almost a year of continuous experimentation, costly mistakes and dedicated learning to master the frameworks I now teach in my private seminars and client programs. I created this guide so you don't have to spend a year figuring it out on your own.

@aivideostrategy

What’s next

1. Follow for new prompts and tips every week.
2. Make your first video and tag @aivideostrategy.
3. Unlock the next steps for professional results here.

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